08-31 第1篇

阅读理解（说明文） Why Do We Dream at Night?

① Almost everyone dreams. Some dreams are soft and lovely — flying over a green hill, talking to an old friend, eating noodles that never end. Some dreams are strange — our maths teacher suddenly speaks French, or we go to school wearing only one sock. A few dreams are frightening. Every morning, many of them slip away before we can catch them. Yet a very simple question still puzzles scientists after many years of research: **why do we dream at all?**

② To understand dreams, we first need to understand sleep. A full night of sleep is not one long dark tunnel; it is a **journey of cycles**. During each cycle, which lasts about **90 minutes**, our brain moves through several stages, from light sleep, to deep sleep, and finally to a special stage called **REM sleep**. REM stands for "**rapid eye movement**", because under our closed eyelids, our eyes dart quickly from side to side, almost as if we were watching a film. Most of our **vivid dreams** take place during these REM stages, even though shorter dreams can happen in lighter sleep too.

③ What is the brain actually doing in REM sleep? Scientists used to think the brain was simply "resting". Modern research, using machines such as **fMRI scanners**, tells a different story. The brain is surprisingly **busy** during REM. Many areas linked to emotion, memory, and imagination become very active, while the part that controls careful logical thinking becomes quieter. That may be one reason dreams so often feel strong, colourful, and at the same time slightly **crazy**.

④ One leading idea is that dreams help us **sort our memories**. During the day, our brain takes in a huge amount of information: new English words, a quarrel with a classmate, the last goal of a football match, an interesting story in history class. At night, in REM sleep, the brain replays these pieces, strengthens the important ones, and quietly throws away many small details. In one study, students who slept **after** learning new vocabulary remembered the words **better the next day** than students who stayed up late. So dreams may be, in part, the brain cleaning and tidying up our memories.

⑤ Another idea is that dreams help us **practise emotions safely**. In dreams, we may fall, lose our school bag, stand on a stage with no clothes, or meet something scary. These situations would be hard in real life, but in a dream they happen without any real danger. Some scientists believe this gives our feelings a kind of "**night practice**". We wake up slightly more ready to face stress, mistakes and fear. That may be why, after crying in a dream, many students say they feel strangely calm during the morning lessons.

⑥ A third idea connects dreams to **creativity**. History records many artists, writers and scientists who got a new idea from a dream. **Mendeleev**, a Russian scientist of the 19th century, said the pattern of his famous **periodic table** came to him in a dream after weeks of tired thinking. Whether this story is totally true or not, researchers have found that students who take a short nap with dreams often solve difficult puzzles better than those who do not sleep at all.

⑦ Not all dreams are pleasant, of course. Occasional **bad dreams** are a normal part of growing up, especially when we are worried or under stress. Scientists say eating late, using phones in bed, and sleeping in a noisy room can all make bad dreams more likely. Keeping a regular **bedtime**, going to bed only when tired, and leaving screens outside the bedroom are simple habits that help most students have calmer nights.

⑧ We still do not fully understand every dream. What exactly is a dream trying to tell us when we ride a purple elephant to school? Probably nothing mystical: it may be our brain putting together memory pieces in new ways. But if dreams help us sort our memories, train our emotions, and sometimes spark fresh ideas, then those strange night stories may be doing **important day-time work**. So next time you wake up from a dream, don't be in a hurry to forget it. Give it one quiet minute. Your brain may be telling you what it has been busy with all night.

注释： REM sleep 快速眼动睡眠；fMRI scanner 功能磁共振成像仪；vivid 生动的；periodic table 元素周期表；nap 小睡

根据文章内容，选择最佳答案。

1. How long does each sleep cycle last, according to the passage?

A. About 30 minutes.
B. About 60 minutes.
C. About 90 minutes.
D. About 3 hours.

2. What does "REM" in "REM sleep" stand for?

A. "Rest, Eat, Move".
B. "Rapid eye movement".
C. "Read every morning".
D. "Really early morning".

3. Which idea about dreams is NOT mentioned by the writer?

A. Dreams help us sort and keep our memories.
B. Dreams may be a safe place to practise our emotions.

C. Dreams can sometimes spark new ideas.
D. Dreams can tell us exactly who will win a future football match.

4. According to the passage, which habit would most likely cause more bad dreams?

A. Going to bed at a regular time.
B. Using phones in bed late at night.
C. Leaving screens outside the bedroom.
D. Having a quiet sleeping room.

5. What is the main purpose of this passage?

A. To prove that dreams are a kind of magic.
B. To tell us that dreams have no meaning at all.
C. To introduce the science behind dreaming and its possible roles in our lives.
D. To advise readers to sleep only during daytime.

答案与解析

1.
【答案】C
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第②段 "each cycle, which lasts about 90 minutes"
【解析】一个完整睡眠周期约 90 分钟。A、B、D 均错。故选 C。

2.
【答案】B
【题型】词义理解题
【定位】第②段 "REM stands for 'rapid eye movement'"
【解析】REM = 快速眼动。其余均为无关词组。故选 B。

3.
【答案】D
【题型】细节判断题（否定型）
【定位】第④⑤⑥段分别介绍整理记忆、情感练习、创造力
【解析】文章从未说梦能预测比赛结果。A、B、C 均有原文依据。故选 D。

4.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第⑦段 "eating late, using phones in bed, and sleeping in a noisy room can all make bad dreams more likely"
【解析】睡前玩手机会增加噩梦。A、C、D 均为有益习惯。故选 B。

5.
【答案】C
【题型】主旨大意题
【定位】全文围绕"为什么做梦"的多角度科学解释
【解析】文章客观介绍梦境背后的科学与可能作用。A、B、D 均为极端或错误解读。故选 C。